

MADAME HYDRA

FIRST APPEARANCE (Viper as MH) Captain America #110 (February 1969); (MH VI) Nick Fury vs. SHIELD #3 (August 1988)
REAL NAME (both) Unrevealed **OCCUPATION** (both) Subversive
BASE (Both) Mobile **HEIGHT** (Viper) 5 ft 9 in.; (MH VI) 5 ft 11 in
WEIGHT (Viper) 141 lbs; (MH VI) 135 lbs **EYES** (both) Green
HAIR (Viper) Black, green highlights; (MH VI) Brown, dyed green
SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES (both) Formidable combatant.

Originally the subversive organization Hydra restricted its membership to men. The first female Hydra agent was Laura Brown. Another female operative seized command of Hydra's New York operations, took the name Madame Hydra, and battled CAPTAIN AMERICA. Eventually she took a new alias, the VIPER, and became one of the world's most dangerous terrorists. Another female Hydra agent, Madame Hydra VI, clashed with SHIELD and allied with the YELLOW CLAW.

(Five other Madame Hydras outranked her.)

She committed suicide to avoid capture.

Viper has now reassumed the name of Madame Hydra.

PS

MADAME MASQUE

Adopted by financier Byron Frost, Whitney Frost grew up in New York's high society, but when Byron died, her world collapsed. Learning that her biological father was the Italian COUNT NEFARIA, head of the MAGGIA criminal organization, she became his heir. Following his imprisonment, she became head of the Maggia, now based in New York. Her face was disfigured during a botched raid on Stark Industries. Hiding her scars behind a golden mask, Whitney took the name Madame Masque. Falling in love with Tony Stark (IRON MAN), she impersonated his assistant to spend time



It was Mordecai Midas who first suggested the golden mask.

with him, but when

Tony was unable to save her father's life, she resumed her role as the Director of the Maggia.



Over the years, Whitney made several clones of herself, killing them when they'd served their purpose. One, known as Masque, worked briefly with the AVENGERS before being killed. Whitney supposedly renounced her criminal past after witnessing her clone's sacrifice, but she has recently been seen serving as the Hood's top lieutenant in his new crime syndicate. **AD, MF**



FACTFILE

REAL NAME
 Countess Giulietta Nefaria
 (adopted name Whitney Frost)
OCCUPATION
 Head of Maggia criminal organization
BASE
 Unknown

HEIGHT 5 ft 9 in
WEIGHT 130 lbs
EYES Gray
HAIR Black

FIRST APPEARANCE
 Tales of Suspense #97
 (January 1968)

Gymnast and athlete trained to Olympic standards; superb marksman and exceptional mistress of strategy.

POWERS

MADAME MASQUE